MIL-F-50253A (AR)
10 November 1978
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-50253 (MU)
4 April 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FUZES, ROCKET, M423, M427 and M433 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

This specification is approved for use by the US Army Armament Research and Development Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification contains requirements not normally covered by the drawings and provide quality assurance provisions for the fabrication of parts and the manufacture, assembly and packing Fuze Rockets, M423, M427 and M433 with booster and booster lead for the 2.75 Inch Folding Fin Aerial Rocket.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-E-14970	Explosive Composition A5
MIL-P-45486	Pellets, RDX
MIL-A-48078	Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification for
MIL-P-60412	Packaging, Packin and Marking for Shipment of Artillery Type and Rocket Fuzes,

FSC: 1340

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Attn. DRDAR-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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DRAWINGS (see 6.5)

US ARMY ARMAMENT RES EARCH AND DEVELOPMENT COMMAND

- PRODUCT AND PACKAGE DRAWINGS

8883683	Fuze, Rocket, M423 (Loading)
8883745	Fuze, Rocket, M427 (Loading)
9254708	Fuze, Rocket, M423, M427 (Loading)
9260701	Fuze, Rocket, M433 with Booster and Booster Lead

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement function should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.- Materials shall be in accordance with applicable draeings and specifications.

3.2 Fuze Assemblies and Parts.- the fuze assemblies and parts shall comply with all requirements specified on drawings 8883683, 8883745, 9254708 or 9260701 (which is applicable) and associated drawings and with all requirements specified in applicable standards and specifications. Ambient temperature is defined as 70°F ± 15°F unless otherwise specified.

3.3 Explosive Pellets.- The RDX and Explosive Composition A5 pellets shall meet the requirements of MIL-P-45486 with the exception that the composition of the Explosive Composition A5 shall be in accordance with MIL-E-14970.

3.4 Radiographic Inspection.- Fuzes shall be radiographer perpendicular to the longitudinal axis. Inspection for armed or partially armed fuzes and inspection for broken or missing components may be made simultaneously.

3.5 Booster Functioning.- The booster, when placed in a fuze assembly (M423, M427 and M433) or the booster output test fixture assembly (M433 only) (with live booster) shall detonate high order upon initiation.

3.6 Ballistic Firing.

a. The M423/M427 fuze shall cause the warhead to detonate high order upon impacting natural ground surface.

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b. The M433 fuze shall cause the warhead to detonate high order upon impacting natural round surface in "super quick" mode or after a given number of milliseconds as determined by the predetermined fuze set time.

3.7 Umbilical Continuity (M433),- (Fuze Unarmed).- The continuity of the charge circuit through its umbilical, shall be 220 ohms minimum and 3.3K ohms maximum.

3.8 Data Requirements. - The contractor shall generate data in accordance with the requirments of the data item descriptions cited in 4.5.5.

3.9 First Article Inspection.- This specification makes provisions for first article inspection (see Table 1), Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

3.10 Workmanship.- All parts and assemblies shall be free from burrs, chips, sharp edges, cracks, unblended radii, surface defects, dirt, grease, rust, porosity, warpage, burn marks, checks, blisters, excess flash, corrosion products and other foreign matter. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any part nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agents. Surface coating shall be continuous except for a few slight scratches not exposing base material. The loading and assembly operations shall be performed in a thorough, workmanlike manner consistent with the best practices of industry. All required markings shall be clear and sharply defined.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVIS IONS

4.1 Responsibility for Inspection and Standard Quality Assurance Provisions.- Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made part of this detail specification.

4,2 Classification of Inspection.- The following types of inspection shall be conducted on this item:

a. First Article Inspection

b. Quality Conformance Inspection

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4,3 First Article Inspection.

4.3.1 Submission.- The contractor shall submit a first article sample as designated by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with provisions of 4.3,2. The first article sample shall consist of the following items that are applicable to this Contract in sample quantities as indicated:

Part description	Drawings	Quantity
Fuze, Rocket, M423 (Loading)	8883683	74
Fuze, Rocket, M427 (Loading)	8883745	74
Fuze, Rocket, M423, M427 (Loading)	9254708	74
Fuze, Rocket, M433 with Booster and Booster Lead	9260701	74

4.3.2 Inspections to be Performed.- See MIL-A-48078 and Table I specified herein.

4.3.2.1 Use of Simulated Defect Standards.- If automatic radiographic inspection equipment is used, it shall be validated hourly using Design Agency approved standards containing simulated defects and supplied by the contractor. These standards should be representative of defects actually found or anticipated, The contractor shall resupply the item standards when it is determined by the Government that the standards are no longer representative of the product.

4.3.2.2 Undetected Defect Standards.- Provisions shall be established for the corrective action to be taken where the equipment fails to identify a standard as defective. These provisions shall include a reinspection of all acceptable material subsequent to the last acceptable verification check as minimum.

4.3.3 Rejection.- See MIL-A-48078.

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TABLE I - FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-F-50253A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET 1 OF 2	DRAWING NUMBER
	Fuzes Rocket M423, M427, M433 with Booster and Booster Lead		AS APPLICABLE
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Fuze, Rocket, M423 (Loading) (Dwg. 8883683)				
	Examination for defects	74		3.2	4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2
	Booster Function Test	50		3.5	4.5.3
	Ballistic Firing Test	24		3.6	4.5.4
	Fuze, Rocket, M427 (Loading) (Dwg. 8883745)				
	Examination for defects	74		3.2	4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2
	Booster Function Test	50		3.5	4.5.3
	Ballistic Firing Test	24		3.6	4.5.4
	Fuze, Rocket M423, M427 with Booster Lead (Dwg. 9254708)				
	Examination for defects	74		3.2	4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2
	Booster Function Test	50		3.5	4.5.3
	Ballistic Firing Test	24		3.6	4.5.4

NOTES:

DLAR-QA Form 160 Jul 77 Replaces SARPA-QA Form 2567 Feb 74 Which is Obsolete

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TABLE I - FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-F-50253A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 2 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER
	Fuze Rocket M423, M427, M433 with Booster and Booster Lead				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Fuze, Rocket, M433 with Booster and Booster Lead (Dwg. 9260701)				
	Examination for defects	74		3.2	4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2
	Umbilical Continuity Test	74		3.7	4.5.2
	Booster Function Test	50		3.5	4.5.3
	Ballistic Firing Test	24		3.6	4.5.4

NOTES:

DRDAR-QA Form 160 Jul 77 Replaces SARPA-QA Form 2567 Feb 74 Which is Obsolete

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4.4 Quality Conformance Inspection.

4.4.1 Inspection Lot Formation.

a. One metal parts lot from one manufacturer,

b. RDX from not more than one lot or homogeneous blend of lots, dwg. 8883684,

c. Explosive Composition A5 from not more than one lot or homogeneous blend of lots, dwg. 8883685.

4.4.2 Examination.- Unless otherwise specified in the Classification of Defects and Test Tables, sampling plans for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Normal Inspection Level II.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-F-50253A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Fuze Assembly, Prior to Crimp				8883683, 8883745, 9260701, or 9254708
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None defined				
Major					
101	Pellets, pad, or closing disc, missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
Minor					
201	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.10	Visual

NOTES:

DRDAR-QA Form 160 Jul 77 Replaces SARPA-QA Form 2567 Feb 74 Which is Obsolete

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QULAITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-F-50253A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 8883683, 8883745, 9260701, or 9254708
4.4.2.2	Fuze Assembly				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY ----------
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None defined				
Major					
101	Length from shoulder to end of booster assembly, max.		0.40%	3.2	Gage
102	Varnish missing from aft end		0.40%	3.2	Visual
103	Varnish where not permitted		0.40%	3.2	Visual
104	Radiographic inspection		100%	3.4	Gage
105	Umbilical Continuity Test (a)		0.40%	3.7	4.5.2
106	Booster Function Test	50		3.5	4.5.3
107	Ballistic Firing Test	24		3.6	4.5.4
Minor					
201	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable		0.65%	3.2	Visual
202	Protective finish inadequate		0.65%	3.2	Visual
203	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.10	Visual

NOTES: (a) M433 fuze only

DRDAR-QA Form 160 Jul 77 Replaces SARPA-QA Form 2567 Feb 74 Which is Obsolete

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4.4.3 Testing is described in the First Article and Quality Conformance Inspection Tables.

4.4.4 Inspection Equipment.- The inspection equipment required-to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the "Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method" column in the tables starting with paragraph 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment desires in accordance with the terms of the contract, See section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and section 6.3 herein,

4.5 Methods of Inspection.

PRECAUTION: This specification covers sampling and testing of chemical, toxic or explosive materials which are potentially hazardous to personnel. Accordingly, it is emphasized that all applicable safety rules, regulations and procedures must be followed in handling and processing these materials.

4.5.1 Materials, Components and Processes.- Compliance with all requirements of Section 3 of this specification shall be ascertained by current and continuing examinations of inspection and test data to determine that all components (parts, subassemblies, and materials) have been inspected and tested and found to comply with their respective drawing and specification requirements and that all specified manufacturing processes have been followed.

4.5.1.1 Visual and Mechanical Inspection.- The visual, manual and mechanical inspections and tests shall verify compliance with the requirements of Section 3 and 5 of this Specification in accordance with 4,4.2 herein and Table I.

4.5,2 Umbilical Continuity Test.- Each fuze umbilical shall be connected to an unibilical continuity tester that has an output pulse width of 100 ± 10 MS, output impedance of 150 K ohms typical and having an output open circuit voltage of 100 + 10 millivolts. Each umbilical must meet the acceptance requirements. Any fuze that does not meet the acceptance requirements shall be classed defective.

4.5.3 Booster functioning.

4.5,3.1 Booster Function Sampling and Acceptance Criteria,- Beginning with the first production lot, fifty 50) complete fuzes (or M433 fuze simulator) with live boosters shall be selected and tested from each lot. If two or more fuzes or simulated fuzes fail to detonate high order, the lot shall be rejected. The fifty (50) samples shall all be fired regardless of the failure rate.

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4.5.3.2 M423/M427 Fuzes.- The assembled fuze shall be armed on a centrifuge by application of 40.0 gravities "g's" maximum for a minimum of three (3) seconds which simulates a rocket launching. Radiographic inspection shall be utilized to verify that each unit is armed and has no defective or missing internal parts. For functioning, each fuze shall be positioned vertically on top of an aluminum witness block. Each fuze shall be functional by dropping a fifty (SO) to fifty-one (51) pound weight from a height of 5.0 feet to 5.5 feet onto the nose of the fuze. The weight shall be dropped only once. High order detonation shall be determined by a 0.25 inch minimum dent in the cylindrical witness block (1.5 inch minimum height by 2.0 inch minimum diameter of 2011-T3 aluminm).

WARNING: This test is dangerous and must be performed behind a suitable barricade.

4.5.3.3 M433 Fuze.- The assembled fuze shall be charged for a delay time of 20MS and then armed on a centrifuge by application of 40.0 g's maximum for a minimum of (3) seconds which simulates rocket launch. Electrical inspections, via the umbilical, shall verify that each unit is armed. The fuze shall then be placed on the test firing fixture and the fuze impact sensor probe actutated. After a 20MS delay the M433 fuze shall detonate high order. The delay time need not be recorded for this test. A government approved simulated fuze may be used in place of an actual M433 fuze, in which case centrifuging and radiographic inspections are not required. The fuze or test fixture must employ an M433 S&A device containing an M84 electric detonator or equivalent. The S&A device need not be operational, but must be capable of being armed when used in the simulated M423 test fixture. Functional (electrical) energ of not less than 750 ergs shall be applied to the detonator electrical contacts in the simulated test fixture.

In either case, high order detonation shall be determined by a 0.25 inch minimum dent in the cylindrical witness block (1. 5 inch minimum height by 2.0 inch minimum diameter of 2011-T3 aluminum).

WARNING: This test is dangerous and must be performed behind a suitable barricade.

4.5.4 Ballistic Test.

4.5.4.1 Ballistic Sampling and Acceptance Criteria.- This test shall be performed on warhead-fuze combination lots. All

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sample assemblies shall be numbered and x-rayed for information only. The assemblies shall be shipped to the proving grounds, retaining the identification number and attached to motors for ballistic test. A random sample of twenty-four (24) loaded fuzed warheads shall be selected from each lot, Should two or more rounds fail to detonate high order, the lot shall be rejected. Should one round fail to detonate high order, an additional twenty-four (24) samples shall be tested. Should one or more of these additional twenty-four (24) samples fail to detonate high order, the lot shall be rejected,

4.5,4.2 Ballistic Functional Criteria,- The complete fuze with warhead and rocket motor shall be fired from a launcher at a minimum height of 35 feet to impact the round at a minimun-range of 500 yards. The launch tower shall use a Standard 2,75 Inch Rocket Launcher (or equivalent) which has an inside diameter of 2,822 ± .010 inches and a detent to restrain the rocket until a thrust of 200 ± 10 pounds is developed. Each launch fixture shall be inspected for compliance with the required diameter and release force a minimum of once per month. Defective launcher components shall be replaced as needed. A high order warhead function which occurs on second impact shall be considered a valid test. Acceptable high order warhead functions may occur short of the intended 500 yard range since M423 and M433 fuzes can be armed at a minimum range of 50 yards and M427 fuzes can be armed at a minimum range of 150 yards. Duds at ranges below 500 yards shall be discounted from the test results. Unobserved impacts shall be indicated as such and may be discounted from the test results if sufficient information is not available to make a functional determination. Ballistic reports of samples which contain more than one fuze lot shall include round by round data of which fuze lot each round represents.

4.5.5 Data Items.- The contractor shall submit a quality inspection test demonstration and evaluation report in accordance with Data Item Description DI-F-1721 and DI-R-1724 giving the detailed test results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging and marking.- The fuze assemblies shall be packaged and marked in accordance with MIL-P-60412.

5.2 Packing and marking. The packaged fuzes shall be packed and marked in accordance with MIL-P-60412.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The components covered by this specification are intended for use in the 2.75 Inch Rocket System.

6.2 Ordering data.- See MIL-A-48078.

6.3 Submission of inspection equipment for design approvals. See MIL-A-48078. Submit designs as required to Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDAR-QAR-I, Dover, NJ 07801,

6.4 Data requirements.- Deliverable data required by this specification is cited in the following paragraphs:

Paragraph	Data Requirements	Applicable DID
4.5.5	Quality Inspection Defect Report	DI-R-1721
4.5.5	Quality Inspection Test Demonstration and Evaluation Report	DI-R-1724

(Copies of data item description required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement function should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

6.5 Drawings.- Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research and Development Command (ARRADCOM) may also include drawings prepared by, and identified as Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal or Picatinny Arsenal Drawings. Technical data originally prepared by these activities is now under the cognizance of ARRADCOM.

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Project Number; 1340-A552

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-F-50253A Fuzes, Rocket, M423, M427 and M433 LAP

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B. RECOMMENDED WORDING CHANGE

C. REASON FOR RECOMMENDED CHANGE(S)

2. REMARKS

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NOTICE
OF VALIDATION

MIL-F-50253A(AR)
NOTICE 1
22 APRIL 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FUZES, ROCKET, M423, M427 AND M433 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

MIL-F-50253A(AR), dated 10 November 1978, with Amendment 2, dated 12 May 1982, has been reviewed and determined to be valid for use in acquisition.

Review activity:
Army - EA

Preparing activity:
Army-AR

AMSC N/A

FSC 1340

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INCH-POUND

MIL-F-50253A (AR)
AMENDMENT 3
26 December 1992
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT 2
12 May 1982

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FUZES, ROCKET, W123, M427 AND M433 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

This amendment forms a part of Military Specification MIL-F-50252A (AR), dated 10 November 1.978, and is approved for use by the U.S. Army Armament, Munitions, and Chemical command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 2

* 2.1: Delete
"9260701 - Fuze, Rocket, M433 with Booster and Booster Lead"
and substitute
9260701 - Fuze, Rocket, M433.

* Add
"9329860-3 - M433/M439 Fuze Continuity Test Set".

PAGE 3

* 3.7: Add "NOTE: THIS ELECTRICAL, CHARACTERISTIC IS AN ELECTRICAL INTERFACE CHARACTERISTIC AND SHALL NOT BE ALTERED OR CHANGED WITHOUT AN APPROVED GOVERNMENT DEV/WAV OR ECP .".

PAGE 4

4.3.1: Delete "Fuze, Rocket, M433 with Booster and Booster Lead" and substitute "Fuze, Rocket, M433".

PAGE 5

TABLE 1: Delete with Booster and Booster Lead

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PAGE 6

TABLE I: In two places, "w/booster and booster lead".

PAGE 7

4.4.1: Delete
"a. One metal parts lot from one manufacturer" and substitute "Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078. In addition, each inspection lot of boostered fuzes shall contain:

a. Fuzes bearing the same metal parts lot interfix number from one metal parts manufacturer".

PAGE 9

4.4.2.2, Major 105: Delete "0.40%" and substitute "100%".

PAGE 10

* 4.5.2: Delete in its entirety and substitute:

Umbilical Continuity Test. Each fuze umbilical shall be connected to an Umbilical Test Set (9329860-3). Each umbilical must meet the acceptance requirements. Any umbilical that does not meet the acceptance requirements shall be classed as defective and removed from the lot.

PAGE 11

4.5.3.2, line 8: Delete "functional" and substitute "functioned".

4.5.3.3: Delete in its entirety and substitute:

"M433 Fuze. Live boosters will be assembled into a government-approved simulated M433 fuze, an M423 Fuze Assembly or an M427 Fuze Assembly. When a simulated M433 fuze is used, the test fixture must simulate an M433 explosive train in the armed condition. Functional (electrical) energy of not less than 750 ergs shall be applied to the detonator electrical contacts in the simulated test fixture. High order detonation shall be determined by a 0.25 inch minimum dent in a cylindrical witness block (1.5 inch minimum height by 2.0 inch minimum diameter of 2011-T3 aluminum). When M423/427 Fuze Assemblies are used, the test procedure of 4.5.3.2 applies.

"WARNING: This test is dangerous and must be performed behind a suitable barricade."

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PAGE 12

4.5 4.2. Line 10, After "needed." Add

"Rounds containing M433 Fuzes shall be set to the superquick mode with a government approved setter design that represents the helicopter setter system."

PAGE 13

* 6.3: Delete "DRDAR-QAR-I: and substitute 'SMCAR-QAF-I".

The margins of this amendment are marked with an asterisk or vertical lines to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous amendment were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations, Bidders and contractors are caut ioned to eveluate the requirements of this document. based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous amendment.

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(Project 1340-A878)

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